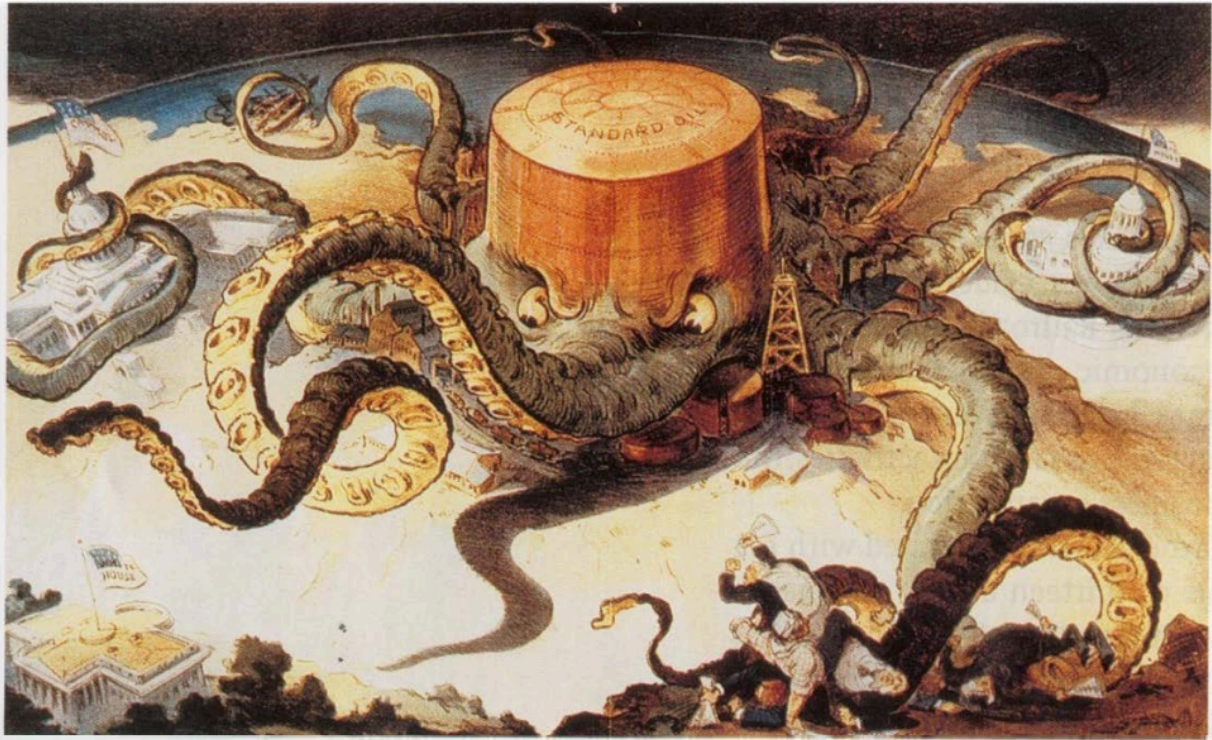




This black and white cartoon shows a dying woman, raising her hand as a final action, laying on the ground, a bloody Rwanda inscribed into her side. A group of onlookers wave back at her in a benign curiosity, wondering what is going on. This is a condemnation of the international communities reaction to the Rwandan Genocide of 1994. About a million Tutsis and Hutus were massacred over 100 days, a magnitude of loss unimaginable to many people. This cartoon reflects the lack of response and intervention by countries that had been watching and listening to the situation on the ground. In the cartoon, other countries look at the dying Rwanda from afar, trying to be polite and cordial, saying things like "She seems to be waving", and "We should wave back, I suppose". Instead of waving hello, Rwanda is waving goodbye, as her people are slaughtered without mercy.



This cartoon, titled "Next!" comes from the Industrialization Era in the early 1900's. It shows a large octopus, with a copper cap with tentacles wrapped around various caricatures. The octopus, representing standard oil, had its tentacles wrapped around numerous sources of power, such as the Capital, the Treasury, copper, steel, and shipping industries, even reaching out towards the White House. It specifically called out the rampant power that large corporations, specifically standard oil, maintained. This seems to symbolize that America is coming to terms with being under the whims of these massive corporations, bending to their will and doing their bidding. It gives an atmosphere of dread, showing the inescapable control of these corporations, usually run by robber barons.



This cartoon, titled "The New Member of the Orchestra", shows a group of men in an orchestra, all carrying various musical instruments, staring down at their new member, a man dressed in American clothing and holding a top hat. Here, the orchestra is referring to the "Concert of Europe", and the newcomer is Uncle Sam. He carries a sheet of paper, referring to the Monroe Doctrine and demonstrating American influence. Some of the European countries have a sour look on their face, while others a more curious tone. This is a representation of the sentiment faced by the United States upon their entering into the world stage. Some countries were not happy to see them, while others watched carefully to see America's next move.



This cartoon shows a proud Ronald Reagan leading a tired Mikhail Gorbachev. This cartoon came out after the collapse of the Berlin Wall, which had much to do with Gorbachev's actions leading the Soviet Union in 1989 Through his policies like glasnost (openness) and perestroika (restructuring), events gave way to the collapse of the Soviet Union and, ultimately, the Berlin Wall. While Ronald Reagan took most of the credit in the eyes of the American people, it was Gorbachev who was the primary instigator for this, and much credit should go to him. The US's indifference to Gorbachev is well explained by Ronald Regan's attitude, calling the man by saying "what's his name", instead of by his real name, and ordering him, not asking him or working with him, to "tear down this wall!"





Ho Hum! No chance of contagion.

By Dr. Seuss

This cartoon, titled "Ho Hum! No chance of contagion" and drawn by Dr. Seuss, is a satirical cartoon in the late 1930s that made fun of the politicians who argued for isolationism from Europe's ongoing battle with the Nazis. It shows Uncle Sam sleeping in his own bed while European Countries sleep beside him, riddled with issues stemming from the war and communism. It was during this time that Congress was determined to keep the US out of war through the Neutrality Laws, but it was clear to many in the American public that this was a vain effort, sooner or later the US would have to deal with the issues going on in Europe because if they did not, those issues would come to them. And come to them they did. This cartoon accurately summarizes the "head in the sand" mentality that the US government stressed during this time, a reluctance that did not stand for long as the war raged out of Europe and into the rest of the world.